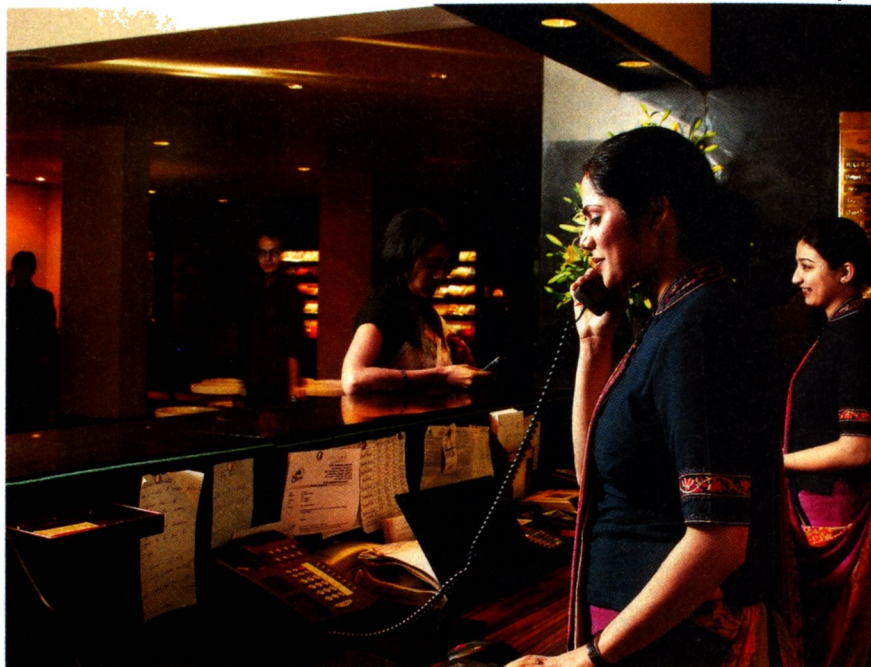


There are a host of Indian and multinational facility management companies that typically offer hard and soft services in the country. While the soft functions include front-end services like managing the reception and support staff of a facility, the hard services require skills that can help buildings optimise efficiency. A facility manager provides predictive mechanical and electrical maintenance services and Heating, Ventilating and Air-conditioning (HVAC) management. With most new buildings going green, a great deal of talent would be required to manage them and their equipment. MD of real estate developer Lodha Group, Abhishek Lodha, says, "With economic growth, new highrises and corporate facilities will need to be managed efficiently. For this, facility management companies will need people with hospitality and engineering skills."



AUTOMOBILE CLAY MODELLING

The Indian automobile industry is the ninth largest in the world with an annual production of 2.3 million units. India is not just a robust automobile market but also a large exporter of small cars. In 2009, India emerged as the fourth largest automobile exporter after Japan, South Korea and Thailand. Going by the bright opportunities, India has laid out an automobile mission plan under which the industry is set to create 25 million jobs by 2016.

With almost every marquee brand driving into the country, India is becoming a hot battleground for cars. From BMW to Hyundai, all auto majors are striving to develop products relevant to the Indian market. For this, they are going to need people who can design and model cars that are good both functionally as well as in looks.

Automobile design comprises three segments—exterior design, interior design, and colour and trim design. First a car is designed graphically on a computer and then translated into a physical model. A stylist responsible for the exterior design works with digital or manual images of the car design and then translates it into a clay (industrial plasticine) model. Design and dimensional data from this model is

then used to create mockups. With Computer Numerical Control milling machines, the clay model is first designed on a computer and then "carved" using the machine and large amounts of clay. Even in times of 3D software and computer-aided design tools, the clay model is still the most important tool to evaluate car design and, therefore, used throughout the industry. Indian automobile industry is likely to need a lot of clay modellers as demand for localising design is slated to increase.

RURAL MARKETING

From mobile phones to automobiles to consumer durable companies, everyone's making a beeline for India's six

SOFT FUNCTIONS OF FACILITY MANAGEMENT INCLUDE FRONT-END SERVICES

lakh villages. Rural jobs have been in focus for some time. As the world slipped into a recession in 2008, Indian consumption also took a backseat. While urban India was reeling under the impact of the meltdown, rural India remained oblivious to it. Thanks to the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (NREGA), which promises 100 days of employment per year to rural households, 30 million families have got jobs. On the other hand, farmers reaped benefits from higher support prices of staples like wheat and rice. Clearly, this has kicked off a wave of consumption in rural markets, hitherto avoided by most companies, except FMCG players like ITC and Hindustan Unilever.

With urban markets getting saturated, companies are heading to rural India. For this, they require marketing, sales and creative talent. A graduate degree from a rural college coupled with some exposure to rural markets will be a hot pick for most FMCG, insurance, consumer goods and automobile companies. Vodafone is slated to launch a recruitment drive across colleges in rural India to scout for talent which can grow the mobile service provider in India's heartland. ■

WITH AN upsurge of consumption in rural markets, everyone from consumer durable companies to mobile phone and automobile giants is making a beeline for India's six lakh villages.